

software, scan the infected system and then re-enable the interface. Viruses (which come with worms usually) travel mainly via the network and just like the OS, they have no way of knowing whether the network is real or virtual.

Performance impact

Virtualization depends on emulation and sandboxing and when that's done, we're consuming the processor power for doing non-productive work. Most virtualization software available today make the virtual machine work reasonably fast and there are no grave performance issues, specially with processors with virtualization assisting technologies (which almost all processors since 2006 have). However, the one thing which can seriously impact performance is low available memory. With each virtual machine running, more and more memory (RAM) is required. If RAM is inadequate, performance can do down drastically. Also, if the work being done is intensive on the storage media, one must ensure that different virtual machines access different disks at the same time. Apart from that, processor scheduling is taken care of by the guest and the host operating system well enough and you should worry only if all the virtual machines run processor-intensive tasks at the same time and you didn't allocate the number of cores for each virtual machine wisely. 